

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Go bag

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Pack a portable bag with the essentials you need to leave quickly: medicines, documents, contact information, water, food, light, phone power and weather-appropriate clothing. Keep it light enough to carry and a separate grab list for items used every day.

Do now.

**Plan the destination**

01

Know where you can go and how you will get there.

**Pack personal essentials**

02

Include medication arrangements, identification copies, keys and accessible supplies.

**Add basic support**

03

Pack water, snacks, light, charger, hygiene supplies and appropriate clothing.

**Test and maintain**

04

Carry the bag briefly, reduce excess weight and refresh dated items.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If you have minutes rather than days, grab essential medicines, documents, shoes, water and a phone charger first. Divide necessary supplies among people who can carry them, without giving children or a person with limited mobility an unmanageable load.

Watch for.

Never delay an urgent evacuation to finish packing.

People & practical needs.

Pack for actual infants, pets, access needs and the likely transport mode. Agree which adult carries shared items and who stays with each dependent. Include a destination plan; a bag does not establish that a shelter will admit or support the household.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Keep bags accessible and plan for pets, infants and mobility equipment.

Questions in the field.

Does a stocked bag make leaving easier?

Only if it can be reached and carried while managing dependents. Test the load and remove duplication. Keep essential medicine, documents and mobility aids accessible; do not bury a critical item beneath optional equipment.

What if I cannot take the bag?

Leave when immediate danger requires it. Reaching safety takes priority over retrieving supplies. Keep a short written contact plan with each person and identify an alternate source of essential support ahead of time where possible.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[Go bag](#) · [official guidance](#)

<https://www.ready.gov/evacuation>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/go-bag/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.